

Planning
Culminating Writing Project
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Body ¶ 10: One of the Previously-selected Characters from <i>Of Mice and Men</i> :		George
Topic Sentence (Counterargument)	While some readers argue that George's bond with Lennie negatively affected a benefit of George's dream, George's bond with Lennie actually has a positive effect.	
Opponent's Counterclaim - Name naysayer - State opponent's strongest argument - Briefly explain opponent's rationale	Cynical readers might argue that George's bond with Lennie negatively affected a benefit of George's dream based on the reasoning that Lennie's death relieved him of the constant burden of caring for and protecting Lennie.	
Reply to Opponent's Argument (Rebuttal) - Clearly state your position - Include a concession in part	While this reasoning is partially true, it makes more sense that George's bond with Lennie actually has a net positive effect. My opponent's reasoning is partially true in the sense that George's bond with Lennie has a negative effect on George's dream of owning a farm, in that George admits earlier in the novel that life might be easier without Lennie. However, the net effect of George's bond with Lennie is positive.	
C Include a quote that supports your point (but without using a text selection you previously quoted)	According to the text, George tells Lennie, "With us it ain't like that. We got a future. We got somebody to talk to that gives a damn about us." (Steinbeck 13).	
E	This evidence shows that the effect of George's bond with Lennie has more of a positive than negative effect on George's dream of owning a farm because George's love for Lennie is evident in the quote, and his caring for Lennie is what motivates him to work toward the dream in the first place. George's choice to kill Lennie was clearly meant to protect him from a more violent death at the hands of Curley and his mob, which shows	

	George protecting Lennie.
Summary Statement	This evidence shows that George's bond with Lennie actually has a positive effect.

Instructions

Each response should include:

- **R / A: Claim / Topic Sentence / Thesis Statement**- your direct response to the prompt which shows your opinion/position on the topic.
- **C: Textual Evidence / Data**- Direct quotes, or paraphrased information from the text that supports your claim. Make sure you use proper [MLA In-Text Citation \(Parenthetical Citation\)](#) format to cite your evidence.
- **E: Analysis / Commentary / Reasoning / Warrant**- Explain how your evidence supports your claim, or it's significance.
- **S: Summary Statement**- Recap your claim, summarize your main points, and answer the question, "So what?"
- **T: Transitions**- Use transitions to show the relationship among your ideas.